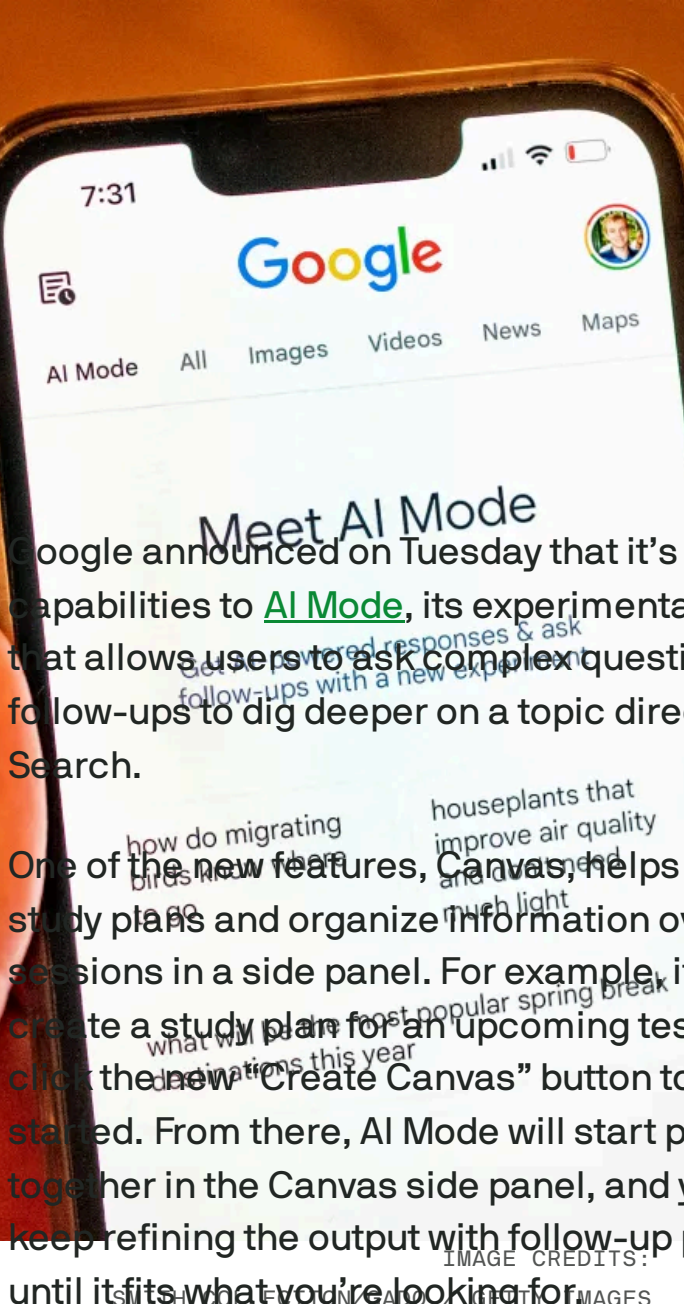


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AI



Google's AI Mode gets
new 'Canvas' feature,
real-time help with
Search Live, and more



Google announced on Tuesday that it's adding new capabilities to [AI Mode](#), its experimental feature that allows users to ask complex questions and follow-ups to dig deeper on a topic directly within Search.

One of the new features, [Canvas](#), helps you build study plans and organize information over multiple sessions in a side panel. For example, if you want to create a study plan for an upcoming test, you can click the new "Create Canvas" button to get started. From there, AI Mode will start putting things together in the Canvas side panel, and you can keep refining the output with follow-up prompts until it fits what you're looking for.

Soon, you will also be able to upload files like class notes or a syllabus to customize your study guide. Users enrolled in the AI Mode Labs experiment in the U.S. will see Canvas in the coming weeks.

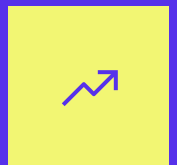
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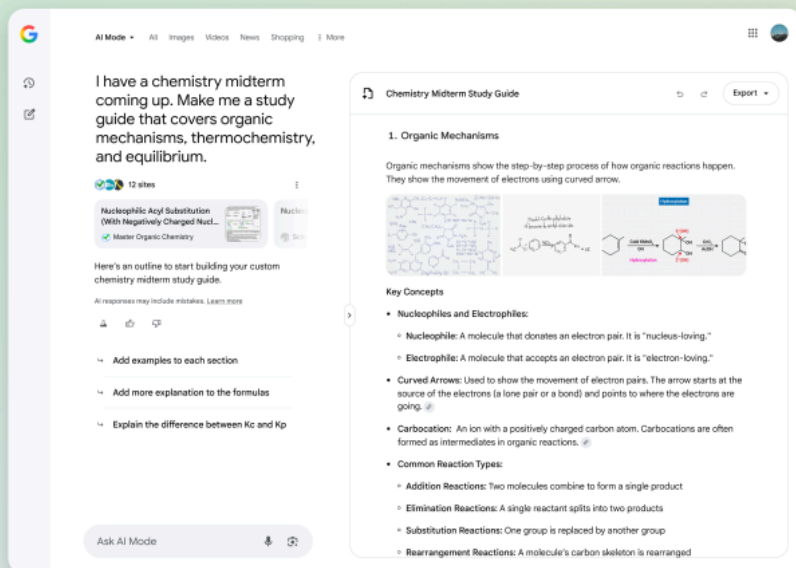


IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

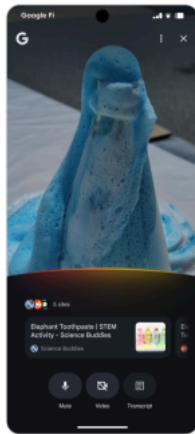
Google is also bringing Project Astra capabilities directly into AI Mode via Search Live, which is integrated with Google Lens, the tech giant’s visual search tool.

“When you go Live with Search, it’s like having an expert on speed dial who can see what you see and talk through tricky concepts in real-time, all with easy access to helpful links on the web,” wrote Robby Stein, VP of Product, Google Search, in a press release.

To use the feature, open Lens in the Google app, tap the Live icon, and ask a question while pointing the camera at something. With this feature, users can have a back-and-forth conversation with Search in AI Mode using visual context from their camera feed.

- The uproar over Vogue’s AI-generated ad isn’t just about fashion
- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines

How can I make this more impressive?



Try using a taller and narrower container to make the foam shoot higher, adding more yeast, and using warm water to speed up the reaction.

IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Search Live with video input is rolling out this week on mobile in the U.S. for users enrolled in the AI Mode Labs experiment.

TC

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In addition, Google announced that users will soon be able to use Lens in AI Mode to ask about what's on their desktop screen.

“Perhaps you're looking at a geometry problem and want to better understand one of the diagrams,” Stein said. “Click on ‘Ask Google about this page’

from the address bar and select the diagram. You'll get an AI Overview with a snapshot of key information directly in the side panel. And this week, you'll be able to follow up with more questions through AI Mode, by selecting AI Mode at the top of the Lens search results or by clicking the 'Dive deeper' button at the bottom of the AI Overview."

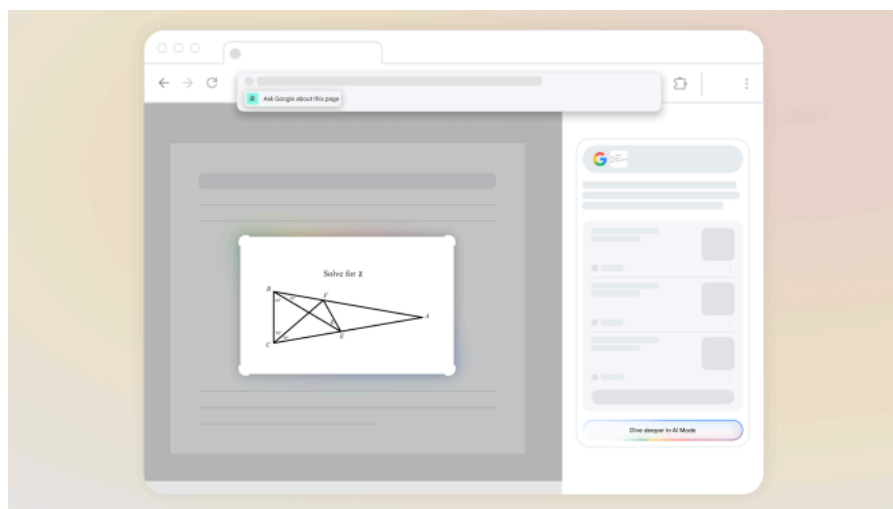


IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Plus, while you can already use AI Mode in the Google app to ask questions about images, you can now do so on desktop as well. Google is also adding support for PDF uploads on desktop, letting you ask detailed questions about documents.

For example, you can upload PDF slides from a school lecture and ask follow-up questions to deepen your understanding beyond the class materials.

Google says AI Mode will support additional file types beyond PDFs and images later this year, including Google Drive files.

Topics: [AI](#) [ai mode](#) [Google](#)



Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter | [X](#) [Twitter](#) [in](#)

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporte...

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AI



Google denies AI search features are killing website traffic

Sarah Perez — 12:45 PM PDT · August 6, 2025

Numerous studies indicate that the [shift to AI search features](#) and the use of [AI chatbots](#) are killing traffic to publishers' sites. But Google on Wednesday denied that's the case, at least in

aggregate. Instead, the search giant says that total organic click volume from its search engine to websites has been “relatively stable” year-over-year and that average click quality has slightly increased.

“This data is in contrast to third-party reports that inaccurately suggest dramatic declines in aggregate traffic — often based on flawed methodologies, isolated examples, or traffic changes that occurred prior to the roll out of AI features in Search,” writes Google VP and Head of Search, Liz Reid, in [a new blog post](#).

Though Google hasn’t shared any specific data to back up its conclusions, even if we assume Google’s claims to be true, this doesn’t necessarily mean that AI isn’t having an impact.

Even Google has to admit this, as Reid acknowledges that “user trends are shifting traffic to different sites, resulting in decreased traffic to some sites and increased traffic to others.”

That word “some” is doing heavy lifting here, as Google doesn’t share data about how many sites are gaining or losing. And while chatbots like ChatGPT have certainly seen traffic increase in recent months, that doesn’t mean online publishers aren’t suffering.



IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

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Google has been revamping its search engine for years to answer more questions directly on the search results page, and now does so with AI through its “AI Overviews” that appear at the top of search results. Google also allows users to interact with an AI chatbot for some queries. Yet Google denies that this is significantly reshaping the search landscape. Rather, it points to users shifting their attention to other sites to start their queries.

Reid explains, “People are increasingly seeking out and clicking on sites with forums, videos, podcasts, and posts where they can hear authentic voices and first-hand perspectives.”

Reading between the lines, it seems like Google.com isn’t necessarily people’s first stop on the web these days. (Google denies this, telling us that Reid’s commentary is only reflective of trends it’s seeing in traffic to sites from Google.)

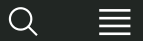
However, we’ve seen this trend for some time. Back in 2022, a Google exec even said that social sites like TikTok and Instagram [were eating into Google’s core products](#), like Search and Maps.

“In our studies, something like almost 40% of young people, when they’re looking for a place for lunch, they don’t go to Google Maps or Search,” said Google SVP Prabhakar Raghavan, who ran the company’s Knowledge and Information organization at the time (he is now its chief technologist). “They go to TikTok or Instagram,” he noted.

Google has also long been worried that Amazon.com had become people’s first stop for online shopping searches, and Reddit.com had become the first stop for researching topics of interest.

Over many years, the company has tried to come up with compelling features for both consumers and

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— it’s not AI that’s entirely responsible for killing search. Search was already dying.

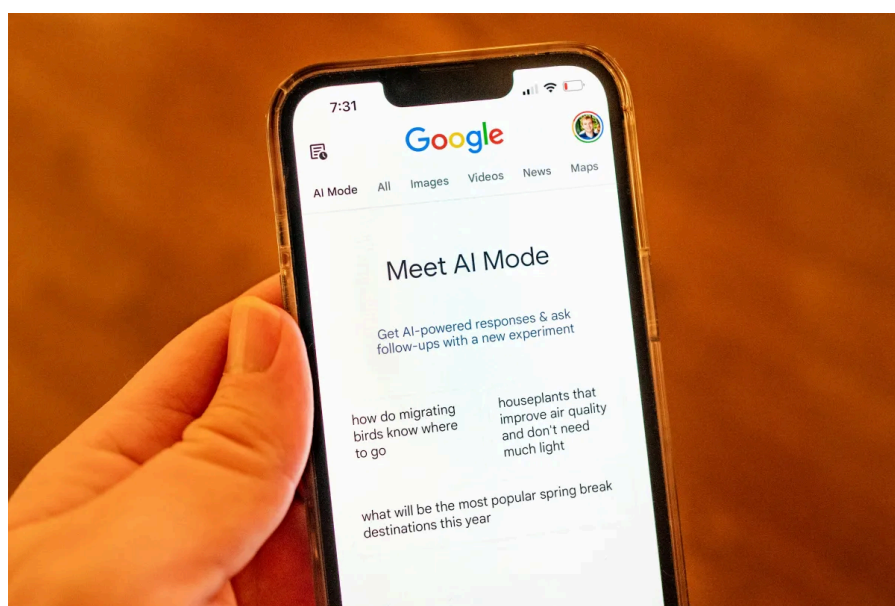


IMAGE CREDITS: SMITH COLLECTION/GADO / GETTY IMAGES

Google’s new blog post also attempts to move the goalposts a bit about what it means for websites receiving Google’s clicks. Now, instead of counting clicks, it wants publishers to think about click quality.

The company says average click quality has increased, and Google is sending “slightly more quality clicks” to websites than a year ago. (Google

explains that a quality click is one where users don't quickly click back — they stay and read.) How much of an increase, though, Google doesn't say. The company only points out that when people click through on an AI response to the source, they're more likely to dive deeper, so those clicks are more valuable.

What's more, Google paints AI as an opportunity for web publishers to gain increased exposure, saying that "with AI Overviews, people are seeing more links on the page than before," Reid writes. "More queries and more links mean more opportunities for websites to surface and get clicked."

But AI, [while a growing referral source](#), isn't [yet making up the difference](#) in terms of clicks, reports have shown. One recent study from Similarweb indicates that the number of news searches on the web resulting in zero clicks to news websites has grown from 56% (when Google launched AI Overviews in May 2024) to 69% as of May 2025.



IMAGE CREDITS:SIMILARWEB

Google appears to know this is a trend, too, as it recently launched [a product for publishers](#) that helps them monetize their dwindling traffic in other

ways that don't rely only on advertising, like micropayments or newsletter sign-ups.

The fact that Google is pushing this “AI is not the end of search traffic!” PR now only makes the situation seem more dire. It's as if Google wants publishers to believe not what their own eyes — and graphs and charts — tell them, but instead take comfort in the fact that Google still sends “billions of clicks to websites” every day, just as the post claims.

Updated after publication with a comment from Google.

Topics: [AI](#) [Google](#) [media](#) [Media & Entertainment](#)
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Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor | [X](#) [Twitter](#) [@](#) [in](#)

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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AI



Google takes on ChatGPT's Study Mode with new 'Guided Learning' tool in Gemini

Aisha Malik — 11:18 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

As the new school year approaches, Google [announced](#) on Wednesday that it's launching a new tool called Guided Learning within Gemini. The tool sort of functions like an AI tutor, as it's designed to help users build a deep understanding instead of just getting answers.

The launch follows just over a week after OpenAI rolled out [Study Mode for ChatGPT](#), which is also designed to go beyond simply obtaining answers to questions by actually helping users develop critical thinking skills.

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Rebecca Bellan - 4 hours ago

Both companies' launches [come amid concerns](#) that AI chatbots [undermine the learning process](#) because they spit out direct answers. The new tools from Google and OpenAI likely aim to address these concerns by positioning their chatbots as learning tools rather than simple answer engines.

With Guided Learning, Gemini will break down problems step-by-step and adapt explanations to its users' needs. The feature responds using images, diagrams, videos, and interactive quizzes to help users build and test themselves on their knowledge, rather than simply giving them the answer.

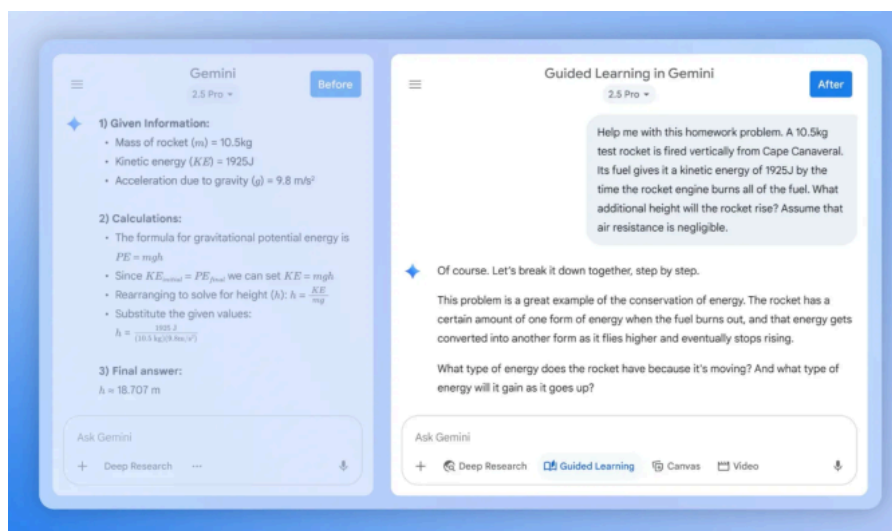


IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

Google says the feature will help users uncover the “why” and “how” behind concepts.

“Whether you’re preparing for an exam about enzymes, starting the first draft of a paper on the importance of bee populations in supporting our food systems, or exploring your passion for photography, Guided Learning is a collaborative thinking partner that helps you get it — each step of the way,” wrote Maureen Heymans, Google’s VP of Learning & Sustainability, in the [blog post](#).

In addition to the new feature, Google announced that it’s working to make Gemini as a whole better equipped to help users learn. Gemini will now

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AI



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Maxwell Zeff - 9 hours ago

automatically incorporate images, diagrams, and YouTube videos directly into responses to help users better understand complex topics. Plus, users can now also ask Gemini to create flashcards and study guides based on their quiz results or other class materials.



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Google also announced on Wednesday that it's offering students in the U.S., Japan, Indonesia, Korea, and Brazil a free one-year subscription to Google's AI Pro plan.

The plan includes expanded access to [Gemini 2.5 Pro](#), [NotebookLM](#), [Veo 3](#), [Deep Research](#), and more.

Topics: [AI](#) [Apps](#) [artificial intelligence](#) [ChatGPT](#)

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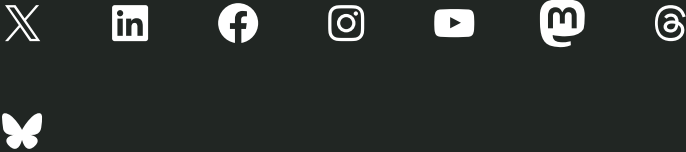
Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter | [X](#) [🐼](#) [in](#)

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